

most video editing software require FireWire for data transfer, it remains the only viable option to ensure that the footage is transferred without any data loss. If you are keen on any kind of editing, FireWire is the way to go. This will not be much of a problem as most modern camcorders incorporate FireWire. You may, however, need to add a FireWire adapter to your PC.

Another advantage of FireWire over USB when used in combination with the MiniDV tape format is that it enables video editing programs—such as Windows Movie Maker—to automatically recognise the tape and ease the data transfer process.

1.3. PC Requirements And Accessories

1.3.1 PC Requirements

The choice of your PC for your editing needs is linked to the camcorder interface. As mentioned, FireWire is essential, and if your PC doesn't have a port, you should get a FireWire adapter card. If your camcorder supports the memory card (SD Card, Memory Stick, Memory Stick Pro etc) option, then you will also require a card reader attached to your PC.

Video editing is largely a processor-intensive task and a faster PC is always preferable (dual core is best) with 1GB or more of RAM. The PC should at least be a Pentium 4 1.0 GHz with 1 GB of RAM, and sufficient hard disk space for your video files. An hour of raw (uncompressed) video footage requires roughly 14 GB, excluding any space for any other supporting files. You could require three to four times the size of your original video file, as you will want to make copies, cut, splice, and join different lengths of the “film” during the editing process.

1.3.2. Accessories and Optional Features

Other than the camcorder itself, you may also want to look at accessories depending on your needs.